

World War II: Causes & Turning Points

1. Root Causes

- Treaty of Versailles left Germany economically crippled and resentful.
- Global economic depression of the 1930s fueled extremist politics.
- Expansionist policies of Germany, Italy, and Japan went unchecked by early appeasement.

2. Key Turning Points

- Battle of Stalingrad (1942–43): halted German advance into the USSR.
- D-Day (June 1944): opened the Western Front in Europe.
- Midway (1942): shifted naval superiority in the Pacific to the Allies.

3. Aftermath

The war reshaped global power structures, leading directly to the Cold War, the United Nations, and decolonization movements across Asia and Africa.